

Meridian Health Plan

Medical Policy MHP-PA-0142

Glucagon-Like Peptide-1 (GLP-1) Receptor Agonists for Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus

Policy Number	MHP-PA-0142	Version	3.0
Line of Business	Commercial	Effective Date	2026-01-15
Next Review	2027-01-15	Supersedes	v2.4 (2025-01-01)

1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This policy establishes the medical necessity criteria applied by Meridian Health Plan when reviewing prior authorization requests for glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1) receptor agonists prescribed for the treatment of Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus (T2DM).

This policy applies to Commercial lines of business. Requests for GLP-1 receptor agonists prescribed for weight management are governed by a separate policy and are outside the scope of this document.

Determinations under this policy must be made against the policy version in effect on the date of service, not the version in effect on the date of review.

2. DEFINITIONS

2.1 Maximum Tolerated Dose

The highest dose of a medication that the member is able to take without experiencing adverse effects that materially interfere with daily functioning, as documented by the prescribing provider.

2.2 Documented Intolerance

A clinically significant adverse reaction to a medication that is recorded in the member's medical record by a licensed provider. Documented intolerance includes, but is not limited to, persistent gastrointestinal intolerance, lactic acidosis, or hypersensitivity reaction. A provider attestation in a progress note, discharge summary, or consultation note constitutes acceptable documentation.

2.3 Adequate Trial

A continuous course of therapy lasting at least three (3) consecutive months at the maximum tolerated dose.

A trial completed under a prior Meridian Health Plan product, under a prior member identifier, or under prior coverage from another carrier SHALL count toward this requirement, provided that documentation of the trial is available in the member's claims history or medical record.

Trials need not have occurred within the current plan year.

3. COVERAGE CRITERIA - INITIAL AUTHORIZATION

All criteria in Section 3 AND all criteria in Section 4 must be met, and no exclusion in Section 5 may apply.

3.1 Age

The member is eighteen (18) years of age or older on the date of service.

3.2 Diagnosis

The member has a documented diagnosis of Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus, evidenced by an ICD-10-CM code in the E11 category submitted on at least one (1) claim within the preceding twelve (12) months, or documented in the medical record.

3.3 Glycemic Control

A hemoglobin A1c (HbA1c) laboratory result of greater than or equal to 7.0% obtained within ninety (90) days prior to the date of the request.

4. STEP THERAPY REQUIREMENTS

The member must have completed an adequate trial, as defined in Section 2.3, of the agents specified below, OR have a documented intolerance or contraindication to each.

4.1 First-Line Agent - Metformin

An adequate trial of metformin at the maximum tolerated dose, OR a documented intolerance or contraindication to metformin as defined in Section 2.2.

Contraindications to metformin include eGFR below 30 mL/min/1.73m², acute or chronic metabolic acidosis, and known hypersensitivity.

4.2 Second-Line Agent

An adequate trial of EITHER a sodium-glucose cotransporter-2 (SGLT2) inhibitor OR a sulfonylurea, OR a documented intolerance or contraindication to both classes.

5. EXCLUSIONS

Authorization SHALL NOT be issued under this policy, and the request must be referred to a clinical reviewer, if any of the following apply.

5.1 Thyroid Malignancy Risk

A personal or family history of medullary thyroid carcinoma (MTC), or a personal history of Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia syndrome type 2 (MEN2). Family history documented in a clinical note is sufficient to trigger this exclusion.

5.2 Pregnancy

The member is currently pregnant, or has documented intent to conceive within the authorization period.

5.3 Prior Hypersensitivity

A documented history of severe hypersensitivity reaction to any GLP-1 receptor agonist.

6. AUTHORIZATION DURATION

Initial authorizations approved under this policy are granted for a period of twelve (12) months from the date of approval.

7. REAUTHORIZATION CRITERIA

Continuation of therapy requires documentation of a reduction in HbA1c of at least 0.5 percentage points from the pre-treatment baseline, OR attainment of an HbA1c below 7.0%, together with confirmation of ongoing treatment adherence.

8. DOCUMENT HISTORY

Version 3.0, effective 2026-01-15. Revised Section 2.3 to clarify that trials completed under prior coverage count toward step therapy requirements. Revised Section 4.2 to permit SGLT2 inhibitors as an alternative to sulfonylureas.

Version 2.4, effective 2025-01-01. Superseded.

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